

## Emacs support for editing Changelog files 🚧

| Description                                                  | Keystroke                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Function                                                                                                                | Note                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <a href="#">Changelog Files</a>                              | Emacs natively supports the <b>change-log-mode</b> for editing <a href="#">Changelog files</a> .<br> PEL enhance Emacs' support when <b>pel-use-changelog</b> user-option is set, providing some extra key bindings and providing access to this PDF.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Last updated on:                                             | 2026-09-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | See <a href="#">Emacs Change Log Commands</a>                                                                           | This mode is related to VCS and CVS version control systems. 🚧 The documentation here does not include information about those and might have to be updated. ⚠️                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Open this PDF file.<br>See also: <a href="#">📖 Help/Info</a> | <b>&lt;f12&gt; &lt;f1&gt;</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>(pel-changelog-help &amp;optional OPEN-WEB-PAGE)</b>                                                                 | Open the <a href="#">📖 Changelog File</a> local PDF. With <b>C-u</b> , <b>M--</b> , <b>M- -1</b> or <b>C- -1</b> prefix: open the remote GitHub hosted PDF instead. If the <b>pel-flip-help-pdf-arg</b> user-option is set it's the other way around.                                                                                                                             |
| ChangeLog Control                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Use change-log-mode                                          | <b>M-x change-log-mode</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>(change-log-mode)</b>                                                                                                | Major mode for editing change logs; like Indented Text mode. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Prevents numeric backups and sets 'left-margin' to 8 and 'fill-column' to 74.</li> <li>New log entries are usually made with <b>M-x add-change-log-entry</b> or <b>C-x 4 a</b>.</li> <li>Each entry behaves as a paragraph, and the entries for one day as a page.</li> </ul> |
| Add new entry in the change-log                              | <b>C-x 4 a</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>(add-change-log-entry &amp;optional WHOAMI CHANGELOG-FILE-NAME OTHER-WINDOW NEW-ENTRY PUT-NEW-ENTRY-ON-NEW-LINE)</b> | Find ChangeLog buffer, add an entry for today and an item for this file. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>With an optional prefix WHOAMI (such as <b>C-u</b>) prompt for user name and email (the default values are stored in <b>'add-log-full-name'</b> and <b>'add-log-mailing-address'</b> user-options).</li> </ul>                                                    |
|                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The CHANGELOG-FILE-NAME is the file name of the change log.               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Interactively, it's nil; so the function uses the value of <b>'change-log-default-name'</b> user-option.</li> <li>If the file thus named exists, it is used for the new entry. If it doesn't exist, it is created, unless <b>'add-log-dont-create-changelog-file'</b> is t, in which case a suitably named buffer that doesn't visit any file is used for keeping entries pertaining to CHANGELOG-FILE-NAME's directory.</li> </ul> </li> <li>Third arg OTHER-WINDOW non-nil means visit in other window. Interactively it's nil and therefore uses the current window.</li> <li>Fourth arg NEW-ENTRY non-nil means always create a new entry at the front; never append to an existing entry. Option <b>'add-log-keep-changes-together'</b> otherwise affects whether a new entry is created. Interactively it's nil so it creates a new entry at the front (the top) of the file.</li> <li>Fifth arg PUT-NEW-ENTRY-ON-NEW-LINE non-nil means that if a new entry is created, put it on a new line by itself, do not put it after a comma on an existing line.</li> <li>Option <b>'add-log-always-start-new-record'</b> non-nil means always create a new record, even when the last record was made on the same date and by the same person.</li> <li>The change log file can start with a copyright notice and a copying permission notice. The first blank line indicates the end of these notices.</li> <li>Today's date is calculated according to <b>'add-log-time-zone-rule'</b> if non-nil, otherwise in local time.</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Go to source location of change log tag                      | <b>C-c C-c</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>(change-log-goto-source)</b>                                                                                         | Go to source location of "change log tag" near 'point'. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>A change log tag is a symbol within a parenthesized, comma-separated list.</li> <li>If no suitable tag can be found nearby, try to visit the file for the change under 'point' instead.</li> </ul>                                                                                 |
| Visit changed file                                           | <b>C-c C-f</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>(change-log-find-file)</b>                                                                                           | Visit the file for the change under point.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Move to next note                                            | <b>C-c C-n</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>(add-log-edit-next-comment ARG)</b>                                                                                  | Cycle forward through Log-Edit mode comment history. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>With a numeric prefix ARG, go forward ARG comments.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Move to previous note                                        | <b>C-c C-p</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <b>(add-log-edit-prev-comment ARG)</b>                                                                                  | Cycle backward through Log-Edit mode comment history. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>With a numeric prefix ARG, go back ARG comments.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |